

4.3 Capturing screen activity

Capturing the screen activity can be very useful for demonstrating software, or for making gaming videos. CamStudio is a freeware that allows users to capture the on-screen activity. The memory footprint of the software is very low, so the screen activity will not be hampered by the software. There are a number of advanced features that CamStudio has, to help



CamStudio interface

accentuate screen activity. Install CamStudio, then start it up. Go to **Region > Full Screen**, then click on the **Record** button to start recording right away. The software is minimised to the system tray. To stop recording, right-click on the CamStudio icon in the system tray, and select **stop**.

Apart from capturing the entire screen, you can choose to capture only a part of the screen. Go to **Region > Region**. Now, when you click on **record**, you will have to select the



Selecting a region

area of the screen you want to record. This feature is useful when you want to record the screen without the start bar or capture a video playing on the screen. Another option is to fix the portion of the screen being recorded using the co-ordinates in terms of pixels.

Once a region is set, you can make CamStudio follow the cursor. Instead of recording the whole screen, this approach will highlight the actual activity on the screen. Go to **Options > Enable Autopan**. Now the region of recording will follow the cursor around the screen. When the region hits one of the corners of the screen however, the camera will stop at the edge, and only the cursor will move.